during retrieval missions. The Ryan Model 147 demonstrated the first large-scale operational use of UAVs for combat intelligence, establishing drones as indispensable tools in military reconnaissance and paving the way for future autonomous surveillance systems.



Figure 3.5 Ryan Model 147 “Lightning Bug” (1964) – the first combat-proven reconnaissance drone.⏎

3.5.2.3 IAI Scout (1979)

The IAI Scout (1979), developed by Israel Aerospace Industries (IAI), stands as one of the most influential UAVs of the second generation, marking a major breakthrough in real-time aerial reconnaissance and surveillance. Designed during a period of growing military demand for flexible, unmanned systems, the Scout was among the first UAVs to successfully integrate real-time video transmission, data telemetry, and electronic warfare (EW) capabilities into a single operational platform. Compact, reliable, and highly maneuverable, it set the standard for modern tactical UAVs and firmly established Israel as a global leader in unmanned aerial technology.